18.1 Generalized Anxiety Disorder*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I worry about everything all the time." • "I cannot relax." **Objective** • Restless; muscles tense • HR 100/min • Poor concentration during the interview	**ACTUAL** Excessive anxiety related to persistent excessive worry as evidenced by restlessness, muscle tension and poor concentration.	• Within 1 week, names two triggers and uses one relaxation technique.	• Build a calm, clear and trusting therapeutic relationship. • Help her spot triggers and the early signs that anxiety is building. • Teach slow breathing and progressive muscle relaxation. • Give medication as prescribed and judge its effect. • Refer for psychological therapy such as CBT.	• Considered met when she uses the technique and feels less anxious.
Subjective • "I lie awake thinking." **Objective** • Sleeps 4 hours a night • Tired	**ACTUAL** Ineffective sleep pattern related to anxious rumination as evidenced by difficulty initiating sleep and fatigue.	• Sleeps at least 6 hours.	• Teach sleep hygiene: regular bedtimes, no caffeine after midday, no screens before bed. • Teach a relaxation routine for bedtime. • Discourage daytime naps.	• Goal reached as sleep improves.
Subjective • "Only coffee and cigarettes calm me." **Objective** • Smoking and drinking more coffee	**RISK** Risk for impaired resilience as evidenced by risk factors: chronic anxiety and reliance on caffeine and nicotine for coping.	• Names healthier ways of coping.	• Explain how caffeine and nicotine make anxiety worse. • Support a plan to cut down. • Encourage regular physical activity.	• Met when she uses healthier coping.

*References for this care plan: [31], [35], [59]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.